

M-Pesa Merchant Payments — Reconciliation Summary

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Date: 11 June 2026 · **Scope:** Lesotho, merchant-line (PayMerchant) payments, April–June 2026 **Prepared for:** O&M / Customer Care team

1. What this was about

Customers can pay us two ways on M-Pesa: the normal **pay-bill SMS flow** (which CC captures automatically) and the **merchant line** (“sent to One Power Lesotho Merchant”). Merchant-line payments do **not** reach our SMS system — they only enter CC when we import the monthly merchant statements. Two problems came together (found via Tankiso Potsane, **0231MAK**):

1. Payments made **before** the customer’s account existed in CC could not be matched, and were silently dropped.
2. The merchant statement import had not been run since 12 May, so newer payments were missing.

2. What has been recovered — no action needed

All recovered payments are booked with their **original payment dates and M-Pesa receipt numbers**, fees are verified and fee-debts cleared, and balances are unaffected (historical records only).

Recovery step	Payments	Notes
Missed payments from statement re-import	19 (M5,888)	incl. 0231MAK’s M501 connection fee + M30 electricity
Matched to existing accounts (bulk claim)	40	references cited accounts that already exist
Site-code typo fixes (e.g. 0034SEM → 0034SEH)	2 (M1,000)	TORIKI HULANE’s connection + readyboard fee pair
Matched by payer phone (unique match)	10	e.g. 8 × M200 to 0084SEH, M450 to 0098SEH
Total restored to customer accounts	71	
Confirmed already booked (no double credit)	111	verified against SMS/portal records
Internal 1PWR treasury transfers — fenced off	8 (M720,000)	not customer money; excluded from all customer data

3. What changed in the system (permanent fixes)

- **Register-with-known-account-number** is live in the New Customer wizard (Location step).

- **Unmatched merchant payments are no longer dropped** — they are parked, and the moment an account with the referenced number is registered, the payment **attaches automatically** (fees verify and clear fee-debt by themselves).
- Internal treasury transfers are permanently excluded from customer datasets.

New best practice: when a customer says they paid on the merchant line but you can't see the payment — register/verify their account number first; if the payment is in our parked queue it will attach by itself. If still missing, escalate with the M-Pesa receipt number.

4. What we need from you — 2 short tasks

Task A — 3 payments with unclear account references (10 minutes)

These references don't match any account, and the typo isn't obvious enough to fix safely. Please confirm the correct account (call the customer if needed) and send it back; we'll re-point the payment.

Reference written	Payer name	Phone	Amount	Paid on	Likely intended
0110MAP	PHOMOLO	26656169247	M20	20 May	0110 at MAK / MAS / MAT?
0287MAT	lineo korotla	26657153248	M50	9 Apr	0287MAT doesn't exist — digit typo?
1101MAS	THISETSO MAHLEHLA	26657469985	M200	15 May	0101MAS? 0110MAS?

Task B — 139 payments with no account in the reference (M12,144)

These customers typed only their name (or nothing) as the M-Pesa reference, and their phone number doesn't match any phone we have on file (or matches several customers). Largest first:

Payer name	Phone	Payments	Total	Dates
moeketsi muso	26658960278	1	M1,500	4 Apr
Thakabanna	26658881214	2	M1,000	5 May
Nyokana				
RESITSUOE	26657670936	1	M1,000	7 May
MOKOSHOKA				
MAKHAHLISO	26658088812	2	M1,000	11 May
KHONYANE				
Phallang	26659456772	2	M1,000	13 May
Moletsane				
Kananelo	26659467293	2	M647	1 Apr – 8 May
Potsane				
ZABALESE	26658044650	1	M501	24 May
MOHLEKOA				
MOREMOHOLO	26658355570	1	M499	19 May
MONAMOLELI				
Monyane Thoola	26657044835	1	M300	22 May
MATSEPO	26659522045	1	M300	28 May
THIBINYANE				
...and 94 more payers		129 total	M12,144 total	full list: no_reference_payments.csv

How to action: identify the customer's account from the name (site staff usually know them). Then the **fastest fix is to add/update the phone number on the customer's profile in CC** — once the phone is on file, tell

us and we'll re-run the matcher, which will book all of that payer's parked payments automatically. Alternatively send us **receipt** → **account** pairs and we'll book them directly.

Important — Note for the team: M501 / M499 amounts in this list are likely **connection / readyboard fees** from customers who may not be registered in CC at all yet — same situation as 0231MAK. Those should be prioritised, as the customer is probably waiting for a connection.

5. Customer-facing guidance (reduce future cases)

When guiding customers to pay on the merchant line, ask them to put **only their account number** (e.g. 0231MAK) in the M-Pesa reference — no names, no extra words, and to double-check the site letters. Wrong/missing references are the single cause of all of the above.

*Files: **registration_worklist.csv** (Task A), **no_reference_payments.csv** (Task B), both in **docs/ops/merchant-unmatched**
Engineering contact: MSO. Technical details in **SESSION_LOG.md** (2026-06-11 entries).*